

# Quick Start Guide

From download to your first budget in about ten minutes. Everything runs in your browser, offline, with no account.

## 1. Open the dashboard

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### 1 Unzip the download

Right-click → Extract All (Windows) or double-click the ZIP (Mac).

### 2 Move the HTML file somewhere permanent

For example `Documents > Finance`. Your data is tied to where the file lives, so don't run it from Downloads or from inside the ZIP.

### 3 Double-click `Personal_Finance_Dashboard.html`

It opens in your default browser. Chrome or Edge give the best experience (they support automatic backup); Firefox and Safari work too.

### 4 Bookmark it

Press Ctrl+D / Cmd+D so it's one click away next time.

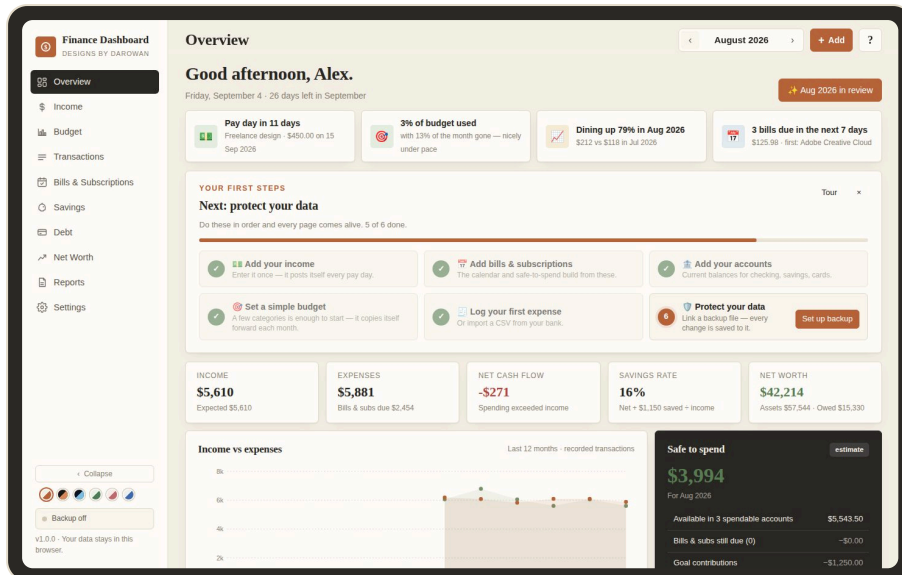
## 2. Setup, tour and first steps

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The first time you open it, a short wizard asks:

- **Who is it for?** Just you, or a couple. Couple mode tags everything to a person (or "joint") and adds per-person breakdowns. You can switch later in Settings.
- **Currency and start month.** The currency only changes the symbol and number format.
- **Pick a look.** Six colour themes, including two dark ones. The dots at the bottom of the sidebar switch themes any time.
- **Sample data or empty?** Choose **Load the sample household** to explore with six months of realistic data. You can wipe it from Settings whenever you're ready.

A short **welcome tour** follows (arrow keys or swipe to move; re-open it with the **?** button). Each slide has a "do this now" button that opens the right form. The Overview then shows **Your first steps**, a six-item checklist that ticks itself off as you go and always points at the next thing to do.



The Overview after loading the sample household.

### 3. Enter your own data, in this order

1

#### Income

Add each salary or income source with its real pay frequency — weekly, fortnightly, monthly, or custom. Set the first pay date; the dashboard works out every future pay day from it.

2

#### Bills & Subscriptions

Add rent, utilities, insurance and every subscription. Give each a due day and frequency. The calendar, cash-flow forecast and safe-to-spend all build from these.

3

#### Net Worth → accounts

Add your current accounts, savings, investments and any credit cards or loans with today's balances. Tick the account types that count as "spendable" in Settings (checking and cash by default).

4

#### Debt

Add each debt with its balance, APR and minimum payment. Toggle Snowball / Avalanche and add an extra monthly amount to see your debt-free date.

5

#### Savings → goals

Target, saved so far, monthly contribution and an optional target date.

6

#### Budget

Type planned amounts straight into the table, or use

#### Suggest from last 3 months

once you have some transactions.

## 4. Day to day

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### Add anything with one button

The **+** **Add** button top-right (or press **N**) adds an expense, income, bill, subscription, account, goal or debt from any page. Forms show the essentials; click **More options** for the rest.

### Log spending

Split one receipt across categories with **+** **Add split**. Or **Import CSV** from your bank — duplicates are flagged automatically.

### Bills and pay days take care of themselves

Income posts itself on every pay day. Tick bills **Paid** (or press **✓** **Mark all due as paid**, or switch on auto-pay in Settings → Automation) and the payment is recorded as a transaction, so the budget and safe-to-spend update instantly.

### Change the month

Use **<** **>** in the top bar, or click the month name to jump. Every page follows it.

### More room when you need it

**< Collapse** at the bottom of the sidebar shrinks it to an icon rail (or press **D**). Every page also reflows for laptops, tablets and phones.

### Print a report

Reports → **Print / Save PDF** for a monthly or annual summary.

### See the month as a story

🌟 **Month in review** on the Overview turns the selected month into a full-screen recap — what came in, where it went, what changed, what you kept — and ends with one suggestion for next month.

## 5. Protect your data

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### Chrome or Edge: turn on automatic backup

Settings → Automatic backup → **Choose backup file....** Pick a location (a Dropbox, Drive or OneDrive folder works well). Every change is written there two seconds later and verified. Nothing is sent anywhere.

### Any browser: one-click JSON backup

Settings → **Export backup (JSON)**. To move to another computer, open the dashboard there and use **Restore from backup....**

### Don't move or rename the file, and don't clear site data

Both start a fresh, empty dashboard. Export a backup first, then restore it afterwards.

Need more detail? The User Guide explains every screen and every calculation.